

Northeastern University
Human Resources

2027 OPEN ENROLLMENT PREVIEW

October 26 – November 6, 2026

Dear Colleagues,

As we enter Open Enrollment, I encourage you to review your benefit options and make informed decisions about your healthcare and financial well-being for the year ahead.

Northeastern remains committed to providing a comprehensive and competitive benefits program that supports our employees and their families. Our benefits program represents a significant investment in our people and plays an important role in attracting, supporting, and retaining outstanding faculty and staff.

Like employers across the country, Northeastern continues to face rising healthcare and prescription drug costs. While the university absorbs the majority of these increases, maintaining a sustainable benefits program requires a shared commitment between the university and employees.

For 2027, Northeastern will continue to invest heavily in employee benefits while implementing certain cost-sharing changes to help address rising healthcare expenses. These decisions were made thoughtfully, with the goal of preserving access to high-quality coverage while ensuring the long-term sustainability of our programs.

In addition, we have introduced enhancements and resources designed to improve the healthcare experience, support informed decision-making, and help employees access high-quality, cost-effective care.

We believe maintaining strong benefits is a shared responsibility. Northeastern remains committed to investing in your health, well-being, and financial security, and we encourage employees to take advantage of available resources, preventive care, and benefit programs to make the most of their coverage.

Thank you for your partnership and for helping us maintain a benefits program that supports our community now and in the future.

Sincerely,
Amy Molway
Interim CHRO & Associate Vice President



Learn What's New for 2027

Medical Plan Changes

For 2027, there are changes across all three medical plans. Here are the highlights:

CORE PLAN

- ☐ The annual deductible is increasing from $500 individual/$1,000 family to $1,000 individual/$2,000 family.
- ☐ The out-of-pocket maximum is increasing from $2,500 individual/$5,000 family to $3,500 individual/$7,000 family.
- ☐ The Emergency Room copay is increasing from $100 to $250 (waived if admitted).

ENHANCED PLAN

- ☐ An in-network annual deductible of $500 individual/$1,000 family will be added to the plan.
- ☐ The out-of-pocket maximum is increasing from $2,000 individual/$4,000 family to $3,000 individual/$6,000 family.
- ☐ The Emergency Room copay is increasing from $100 to $250 (waived if admitted)

HIGH-DEDUCTIBLE HEALTH PLAN WITH HSA

- ☐ The in-network annual deductible is increasing from $2,000 individual/$4,000 family to $2,500 individual/$5,000 family.
- ☐ The out-of-pocket maximum will increase from $3,000 individual/$6,000 family to $4,000 individual/$8,000 family.

Please note: There are increases to out-of-network deductibles and out-of-pocket maximums as well. For full details on all the changes, be sure to review the medical plan comparison in the 2027 Benefits Guide as well as the Summary of Benefits and Coverage found on the Open Enrollment site.

Pharmacy Plan Changes

For 2027, there are changes across all plans. Here are the highlights:

- ☐ Rx copays will increase from $10/$35/$55 to $15/$40/$75 for retail, up to 30-day supply.
- ☐ Rx copays will increase from $20/$70/$110 to $30/$80/$150 for mail, up to 90-day supply.
- ☐ GLP-1s for weight loss will now have a copay of $150 for up to a 34-day supply.

For full details on your prescription drug benefit, please refer to the 2027 Benefits Guide.

Medical Premium Increases

The university works hard to keep premium increases below market averages and focus on cost containment wherever possible, while maintaining a commitment to offering comprehensive benefits. Consistent with this commitment, Northeastern will continue to pay the large majority of our employees' health insurance premiums, however, you will see your per paycheck costs for medical coverage increase for next year. Nationwide healthcare cost increases are something every employer is facing, and we are not immune. There are no changes to dental, vision, or life insurance premiums for 2027. Please refer to the 2027 Benefits Guide for premiums.

Health Savings Account (HSA) Contributions

Northeastern will continue to make an annual contribution to your HSA if you enroll in the High-Deductible PPO with HSA—$500 if you cover only yourself and $1,000 if you cover any dependents. For 2027, the IRS has increased the annual contribution maximums to $4,500 if you cover only yourself and $9,000 if you cover any dependents. (These maximums include the Northeastern contribution along with your own personal contributions.)

New or Enhanced Medical Plan Programs

There are several new or enhanced programs to take note of:

ENHANCED - BCBSMA Provider Search

Now available to employees, there is an enhanced provider search tool for BCBSMA designed to help members identify high-value healthcare providers. The BCBSMA 'Find a Doctor' tool now uses a stoplight color code to highlight providers based on a combination of quality, appropriateness, and cost measures, making it easier for members to make informed healthcare decisions and find quality care that aligns with their needs and budget.

NEW - BCBSMA HelpScript Program

Effective January 1, 2027, Northeastern will add BCBSMA HelpScript, a member support program that helps eligible individuals access manufacturer cost assistance for certain specialty medications that are processed under the medical plan. Through personalized outreach and advocacy support, eligible members may be able to lower their out-of-pocket prescription drug costs. Note that eligible members will be notified as applicable.

NEW - LEAP Infusion Rx

Effective January 1, 2027, Northeastern will add LEAP Infusion Rx, a voluntary program that helps eligible members receive infusion therapy in the home or at a convenient infusion center. Through dedicated care coordination and flexible treatment options, LEAP aims to provide a more convenient, cost-effective infusion experience while maintaining high-quality care. Note that eligible members will be notified as applicable.

ENHANCED - Lantern Centers of Excellence

Effective January 1, 2027, Northeastern University will enhance its partnership with Lantern Centers of Excellence. Beginning in 2027, participation in Lantern will be required for bariatric surgery and will remain voluntary for other eligible procedures and conditions. Through Lantern, eligible members receive personalized support from a dedicated Care Team, assistance locating top-performing surgeons and specialists, and potential cost savings by utilizing high-quality providers and Centers of Excellence.



Use This Checklist to Enroll

Open Enrollment begins October 26 and ends on November 6, 2026. Follow these steps to get ready to choose your coverage.

- ☐ Visit the 2027 Open Enrollment Page on the HR Service Center! The 2027 Open Enrollment page is your one-stop shop for enrollment support. You'll find rate sheets, plan comparison charts, and links to other helpful tools and resources.
- ☐ Prepare and collect any dependent information and documentation you may need if you plan to enroll new dependents. (If you are enrolling dependents in your medical, dental, or vision plans, you must provide dates of birth, Social Security numbers, and other required documentation to complete the enrollment process.)
- ☐ Visit Workday to review your current benefit elections and confirm your personal information is up to date.
- ☐ Enroll/re-enroll in a Health Care and/or Dependent Care Flexible Spending Account (FSA). Per IRS rules, 2026 FSA elections will not carry over.
- ☐ Choose your contributions to your Health Savings Account (HSA) if you're enrolled in the High Deductible PPO with HSA.
- ☐ Check your beneficiary information to ensure your benefits are paid according to your wishes. Review your beneficiary information on Workday for life insurance and through Fidelity or TIAA for retirement benefits.

Contact our benefit vendors directly if you have questions about specific benefit details. (You can find contact information in the 2027 Benefits Guide on the 2027 Open Enrollment page.)

This newsletter highlights certain components of the Plan, but it is only an overview. This guide does not take the place of the official plan documents, which are the final authority on plan provisions used to determine how and when benefits are paid. This guide is a tool for you to use, but you should consult the plan documents, Summary Plan Descriptions (SPDs), Summary of Benefits Coverage documents (SBCs), and any Evidence of Coverage or Certificates of Coverage and their related insurance policies or contracts, for any benefits described in this guide. The university reserves the right to change, amend, suspend, withdraw, or terminate any or all of the plans, in whole or in part, at any time in its sole discretion.

The information provided in this newsletter is subject to bargaining. If you are in a union, the terms of your applicable Collective Bargaining Agreement will apply.

Please review these Important Annual Required Notices.

With a choice of medical options, it isn't always easy to decide what makes the most sense for you. The 2027 Benefits Guide on the 2027 Open Enrollment page includes new employee personas so you can explore how people like you are choosing their medical coverage.

Need More Help?

To get answers to your personal benefit questions, use one of these key resources:

1. Contact a Blue Cross Blue Shield member services representative by calling 1-800-348-7921, selecting option 3, and stating you are a Northeastern employee.
2. Schedule a virtual appointment with an HR Benefits Team member by submitting a Benefits Inquiry.

